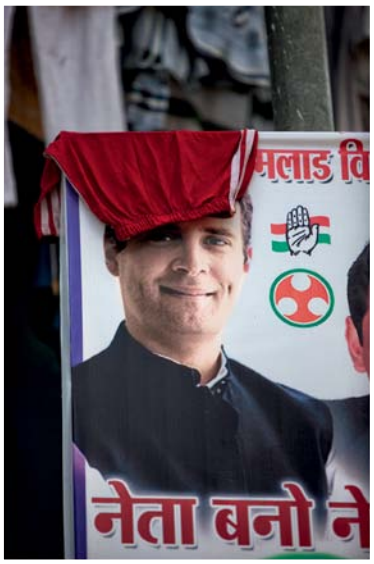


RITESH UTTAMCHANDANI





SIGNS OF THE TIMES
Photographs from Ritesh Uttamchandani's *A Lease of Life* exhibition

PHOTOGRAPHY

Poster Boys

In his debut show, photographer **Ritesh Uttamchandani** *trains his lens on the whimsical afterlife of political billboards*



ART

LOGGING INTO THE MUSEUM

BY HELPING KERALA MUSEUM DIGITISE OVER 200 ARTWORKS, GOOGLE ARTS & CULTURE HAS FURTHERED A REVOLUTION

With the pandemic having made access to physical spaces difficult, virtual, interactive exhibitions have proven to be a boon for art enthusiasts the world over. In Kochi, for instance, Kerala Museum's partnership with Google Arts & Culture recently made available over 200 artworks for online viewing. The use of Gigapixel technology—a photo-capturing process that allows images to be seen in their highest possible resolution—will help viewers explore the museum's paintings in extraordinary detail.

The objectives of Google Arts & Culture are simple—to make more culture available to more people through technology and partnerships; to share collections and knowledge found both in museums and in everyday life. "Curators appreciate the ability to guide audiences through the masterpieces of their collections using the deep zoom features that Google Art Camera technology enables. By integrating these high-resolution images with virtual tours, video, audio, maps and viewing notes, curators can present compelling stories online", says Simon Rein, senior program manager, Google Arts & Culture.

Speaking about Kerala Museum's collection, its director Aditi Nayar says, "In 1984, R. Madhavan Nayar, an entrepreneur from Kerala, initiated the museum in Cochin. He collected 230 paintings and sculptures by iconic artists such as M.F. Husain, Jamini Roy, Ramkinkar Baij and K.G. Subramanyan, with the intent to build a comprehensive resource on modern Indian art, accessible to students and the public." It was this vision that became a



GOING VIRTUAL
The digitisation process of Kerala Museum's art collection